

NDH Project Kickoff Checklist

A practical, one-page checklist for scoping a software, brand, or AI project before you request a quote — use it to arrive at your discovery call with clear answers, which shortens your proposal turnaround.

1. Problem & Goal

- What specific problem are you solving, and for whom (internal staff, paying customers, both)?
- What does success look like 90 days after launch? Pick one measurable outcome, not five vague ones.
- What happens today without this project — manual process, spreadsheet, nothing at all?

2. Scope Boundaries

- List the 3-5 features that must exist on day one. Everything else is phase 2.
- Name at least one thing you are deliberately leaving out of version one.
- If this replaces an existing system, what data needs to migrate, and who owns exporting it?

3. Users & Access

- Who logs in, and what can each role see or do differently (e.g. admin vs customer vs staff)?
- Roughly how many concurrent users at launch, and in 12 months?
- Any compliance constraints (NDPR, PCI-DSS for payments, data residency) you already know about?

4. Integrations & Data

- Which third-party tools must this connect to (payment gateway, SMS/WhatsApp, accounting software, CRM)?
- Do you already have API credentials/sandbox access for those tools, or does that need to be requested first?
- Where will the data live long-term, and who is responsible for backups once the project ships?

5. Budget & Timeline Reality Check

- Is your number a hard ceiling or a starting point for a conversation?
- Is there an external deadline (event, funding milestone, regulatory date) driving the timeline?
- Who on your side can approve scope/budget changes without delaying the whole team?

6. What To Bring To The Discovery Call

- Any existing brand assets (logo, colors, fonts) or a reference site/app whose feel you like.
- Login to your current website/system if one exists, or screenshots if access isn't available yet.
- A one-paragraph summary of the above five sections — it turns a 60-minute call into a 20-minute one.

Published by NDH Agency — a managed software, brand, and AI development bureau. This checklist is original, practical content, not a fictional whitepaper. Questions about any section? Bring them to your discovery call.